Answers and talk notes

Explore Relationships Between Two Variables

What your student is learning

Tonight we build a table of values — input in the first column, output in the second — and find the rule connecting them.

Answers

Ask your student to explain before you look.

1. **B.** Column 1. Column 1, because the input is listed first.
2. **A.** 15. y = 15 when x = 3, because 15 is in the same row as 3.
3. **C.** 3. y goes up by 3, because 6 – 3 = 3 and 9 – 6 = 3.
4. **D.** 13. y = 13, because y goes up by 2 each time and 11 + 2 = 13.
5. **B.** y = 2x. y = 2x, because each y is 2 times x.
6. **C.** 9. y = 9, because 5 + 4 = 9.

Talk about it

Which column is the input and which is the output? What is the rule that connects them?

Home mission

Take a small cup and a bowl. Pour 2 cups at a time. Make a table for 1, 2 and 3 pours. Can your student say which column is the input and tell you the rule?

When they are stuck, ask

- Which quantity could you choose, and which one follows from it?
- Say the sentence: "the ___ depends on the ___."
- How much does y change each time x goes up by one?

Try not to say

- The variable the question asks about is the independent one.
- It does not matter which column each one goes in.
- Just fill in the numbers, you do not need a rule.